

# THREAT ADVISORY



## ATTACK REPORT

### **BATLOADER- Evasive Malware leverages SEO poisoning**

Date of Publication

November 15, 2022

Admiralty Code

A1

TA Number

TA2022256

# Summary

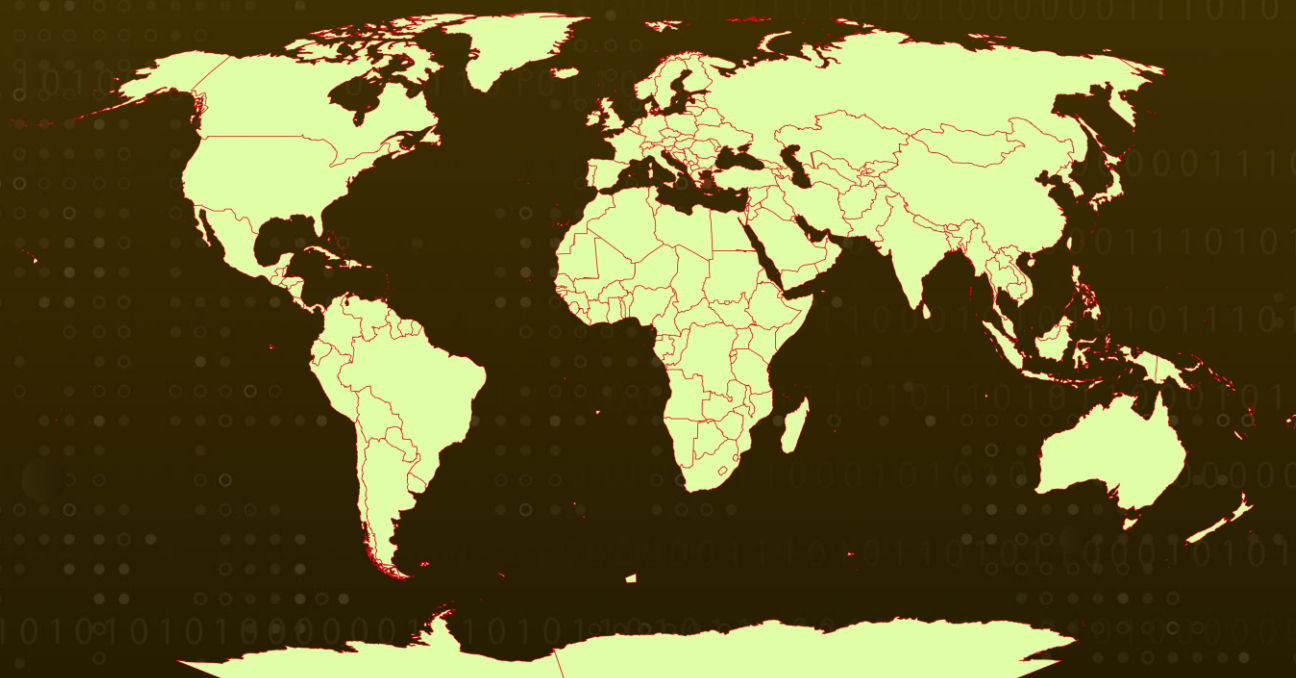
First Activity Observed: July 2022

Attack Region: Worldwide

Targeted Industry: Business services, Finance, Manufacturing, Education, Retail, IT, Healthcare, Biotech, Real Estate, Construction, Utilities, Media.

Attack: Batloader compromise via multi-stage infection chain.

## Attack Regions



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# Attack Details

## #1

"BatLoader" dropper is used to dispense a range of malware tools on victim devices, including a banking Trojan, an information stealer, and the Cobalt Strike post-exploit toolkit. BatLoader malware actors utilize SEO poisoning to dupe potential victims into downloading malicious Microsoft Windows Installer (.msi) files that masquerade as legit software installers.

## #2

After the .msi file is executed, a PowerShell inline script downloads the initial BatLoader script "Update.bat", which starts the infection chain. Update.bat then downloads requestadmin.bat and nircmd.exe, a command-line utility that can be used to gain administrative privileges. Batloader has also been spotted installing remote monitoring software such as Servably's Syncro and Atera RMM. This ensures that malware operators have persistent control over infected systems. During its most recent campaign, BatLoader's stealth and persistence set it apart from the rest.

## Recommendations



### Security Leaders

Phishing simulations and routine education and awareness training and communications rarely account for MFA fatigue and web browser hygiene. Integrate and communicate all lessons learned.



### Security Engineers

- **Uni5 Users:** This is an actionable threat advisory in HivePro Uni5. Prioritize and block all indicators attributed to the threat actors and attacks through your Command Center. Test your controls with Uni5's Breach & Attack Simulation.
- **All Engineers:** Refer to and action upon the 'Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs' & 'Indicators of Compromise (IoC)' on the following pages.

## Potential MITRE ATT&CK TTPs

|                                                        |                                                             |                                                              |                                              |
|--------------------------------------------------------|-------------------------------------------------------------|--------------------------------------------------------------|----------------------------------------------|
| <b><u>TA0042</u></b><br>Resource Development           | <b><u>TA0002</u></b><br>Execution                           | <b><u>TA0003</u></b><br>Persistence                          | <b><u>TA0004</u></b><br>Privilege Escalation |
| <b><u>T1608</u></b><br>Stage Capabilities              | <b><u>T1608.006</u></b><br>SEO Poisoning                    | <b><u>T1059</u></b><br>Command and Scripting Interpreter     | <b><u>T1204</u></b><br>User Execution        |
| <b><u>T1543</u></b><br>Create or Modify System Process | <b><u>T1037</u></b><br>Boot or Logon Initialization Scripts | <b><u>T1068</u></b><br>Exploitation for Privilege Escalation |                                              |

## Indicator of Compromise (IOC)

| TYPE          | VALUE                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                     |
|---------------|---------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>SHA256</b> | 3ec3c66c0099682250fe06db400f42ec7be9a0f4641eaad8473c<br>cd8b28a48042,15c39d2084e399b4a0126c0b1026bd2342f8dc<br>5d812cf0d0caae8e35ee689407,d0d53132fc9db8c4829769e22<br>2d70f25db9740239ac898ee30fad4a89a1197e5,661989f7dedd<br>6a9bd37a69a3c80d6b308b1c704262e8bfc49ea5df45dbd0fce0<br>,9f017523e594c20c536e14b8c3a9bf5932c8a8853b5bdda4e16<br>e9fbd251c72b5,bbbd869ada2a931528437ddfb1626f97058670<br>36131f20db7a9b09318e593638,eed32513227a87faa2439b22<br>17df1c965f9d5cbbf2e3a2b5bac1322c634038da,0c2c349c4f1c<br>420d9810a7a6870d19558542ae9b7233cd4e5ce2142bf381d6b<br>4,1d28ab9852d42bdf12599fd612691a8a68d73b03d80ddcd7a<br>ebf49dad2ea05b5,3ef74a6f1e2372daffc3ef4c98e0b9bb08e22<br>a684c2d1bb8007eb2ba372654a2 |
| <b>IPV4</b>   | 89.108.65[.]136<br>146.112.61[.]107<br>194.67.110[.]215<br>194.67.119[.]190<br>194.135.24[.]245<br>139.60.161[.]74                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                                        |

## References

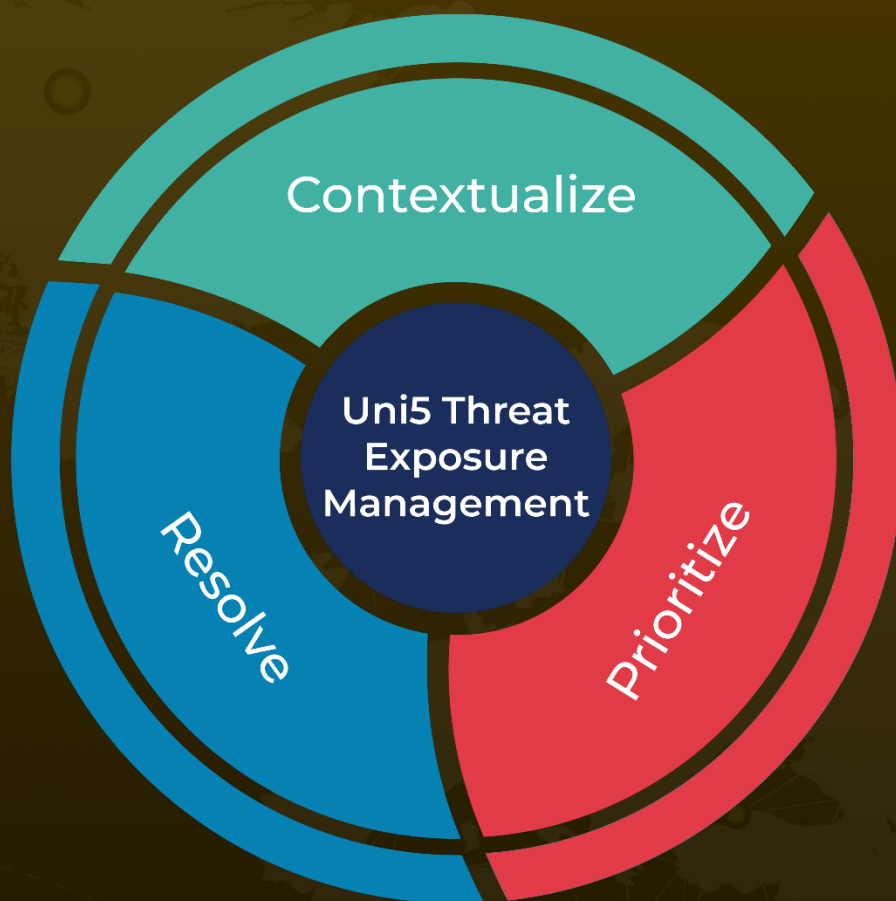
<https://blogs.vmware.com/security/2022/11/batloader-the-evasive-downloader-malware.html>

<https://www.darkreading.com/attacks-breaches/researchers-alarm-batloader-malware-dropper>

# What Next?

At HivePro, it is our mission to detect the most likely threats to your organization and to help you prevent them from happening.

Book a free demo with Hive Pro Uni5: Continuous Threat Exposure Management Platform.



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